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Is a *San Jacobo* a *Cordon Bleu*? Designing a virtual course in agri-food translation

Abstract: Despite the economic relevance of the agri-food sector in Spain, agri-food translation is a pending subject in Spanish academia and is taught only in 9 out of 29 Universities. The aim of this chapter is to detail the revised designing of the “Agri-food translation (English-Spanish)” virtual course taught at the Master’s Degree in Translation of Specialized Texts at the University of Córdoba (Spain). Following a constructivist teaching method along with a task-based learning approach, the course starts with an introduction to agri-food translation and is divided into four main units: 1) text typology in agri-food translation; 2) advertising agri-food translation; 3) culinary translation and 4) scientific agri-food translation. The main innovation of this revision of the course is the introduction of translation technology for agri-food translation. First, given that students are familiar with corpora and corpora management, students will be asked to compile both a parallel and a comparable English-Spanish virtual corpora. Second, students will be introduced to Menutech, a software-as-a-service that has been created to automatize, among others, allergen labelling and menu translation. A future direction would be the implementation of the course as well as its evaluation using both feedback from students and a SWOT analysis.

Keywords: Agri-food translation, culinary translation, virtual course, master’s degree, text typology, Menutech, corpora

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1 Introduction

According to the Spanish Ministry of Agriculture, Fisheries and Food (2019, 2021), the agri-food sector is key for the Spanish economy having a GVA of 107,743 billion euros, which accounts for 9.6% of GDP. Five are the reasons behind these figures: 1) its leadership in world markets, 2) its export potential (with over 50 billion euros), 3) its contribution to creating wealth and employment (2.6 million jobs), 4) its direct relationship to the success of other sectors such as tourism and services and 5) the fact that it is the main economic activity in rural areas. Different campaigns such as “Marketing of Spanish foods in international markets” (Spanish Ministry of Agriculture, Fisheries and Food, 2019) have been promoted to encourage the marketing of Spanish agri-food products all over the world.

As Rivas Carmona & Ruiz Romero (2021: 11) point out, “the role of translators could be a determining factor in the success of export activity and the internationalization process of companies”. However, agri-food translation is a pending subject in Spanish academia: not only has it been barely researched (Ortego Antón, 2020; Ibáñez Rodríguez, 2020; Rivas Carmona & Veroz González, 2018; Gaustad, 2016; Moreno Paz & Rodríguez Tapia, 2015, among others) when compared to other specialized translations such as legal translation or medical translation, but the courses in agri-food translation in Spanish universities are also scarce, having only 9 out of 29 Universities where agri-food translation is taught (Rivas Carmona & Ruiz Romero, 2021).

The aim of this chapter is to detail the designing of the “Agri-food translation (English-Spanish)” virtual course taught at the Master’s Degree in Translation of Specialized Texts at the University of Córdoba (Spain). Starting with an introduction to agri-food translation, the course is divided into four main units: 1) text typology in agri-food translation; 2) advertising agri-food translation; 3) culinary translation and 4) scientific agri-food translation. The different activities, readings and translation briefs will be explained.

2 “Agri-food translation (English-Spanish)” virtual course

The “Agri-food translation (English-Spanish)” virtual course was offered at the Master’s Degree in Translation of Specialized Texts¹ at the University of Córdoba (Spain) during two academic years (2019–2020 and 2020–2021). The course had 4

1 <https://www.uco.es/estudios/postgrado/mastertrad/> (10 May 2023).

ECTS. Since 2021-2022, the course became more specific and changed to “Translation in the agri-food sector (English–Spanish): viticulture and olive growing”. The proposal detailed in this chapter is a revision of the course offered in Semester Two (or Spring Semester) during 2019–2020 and 2020–2021 with new materials and different activities, including, for instance, an activity with a professional menu translator, Menutech, and activities with parallel and comparable virtual corpora.

Following a constructivist teaching method (VonGlaserfeld, 1989) along with a task-based learning approach (Willis, 1996), the purpose of the course is familiarizing students with agri-food translation. Nine learning objectives are pursued:

1. Understand technical agri-food texts.
2. Search resources and documents to accurately translate agri-food texts.
3. Use translation technologies to translate technical agri-food texts.
4. Familiarize with agri-food linguistic features and text types.
5. Learn to use correct agri-food terminology.
6. Develop a methodology to solve difficulties when translating technical agri-food texts.
7. Accurately translate agri-food texts from English into Spanish.
8. Acquire a professional approach to agri-food translation.
9. Reflect upon the professional aspects of agri-food translation.

Starting with an introduction to agri-food translation, the course is divided into four main units: 1) text typology in agri-food translation; 2) advertising agri-food translation; 3) culinary translation and 4) scientific agri-food translation. All the units share the same structure: first, the readings of several papers focused on the topic of the unit and, second, an individual activity to be carried out. In the same vein, the other tasks from the different activities will be assessed as follows:

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- | | |
|--|-------|
| 1. Inadequacies affecting the comprehension of the original text | |
| 1.1. Countersense | –1 |
| 1.2. False sense | –0.5 |
| 1.3. Nonsense | –0.75 |
| 1.4. Addition | –0.25 |
| 1.5. Omission | –0.25 |
| 1.6. Cultural reference | –0.25 |
| 1.7. Different sense | –0.25 |
| 1.8. Linguistic variation | –0.25 |
| 1.9. Terminology | –0.5 |
| 2. Inadequacies affecting the expression in the translation language | |
| 2.1. Spelling and punctuation | –1 |
| 2.2. Grammar | –1 |
| 2.3. Lexicon | –1 |
| 2.4. Textual | –1 |
| 2.5. Writing | –1 |

3. Pragmatic inadequacies	-1
4. Good solutions	
4.1. Good equivalence	+0.75
4.2. Excellent equivalence	+1
5. Style	

As to the evaluation of activities, the translation briefs will be assessed using the following scale based on Hurtado Albir (1999, 2001):

1. Compilation of parallel and comparable corpora. Two main aspects will be assessed: on the one hand, relevance and appropriateness of design criteria and corpora compilation process, and, on the other hand, adequacy of the corpora sources.
2. Reports. The following criteria will be assessed: purpose, content, organization, length, use of references, and capacity for reflection.

2.1 Introduction to agri-food translation

Given that most students have limited knowledge or experience related to agri-food translation, the course starts with five recommended readings to learn some basic aspects of this type of translation.

1. Several pages from the report “Memoria descriptiva. PERTE agroalimentario” (Spanish Ministry of Industry, Trade, and Tourism, 2022) as an introduction to the agri-food sector.
2. The article “La situación de la traducción agroalimentaria en la investigación y la formación en España” (Moreno Paz & Rodríguez Tapia, 2015). It offers a comprehensive list of the research and academic programs that include agri-food translation in Spanish Translation and Interpreting studies.
3. The article “Competencia documental para la traducción agroalimentaria EN-ES: fuentes de información y su evaluación” (Durán Muñoz & Del Moral Álvarez, 2014). It presents a selection of resources related to the English-Spanish agri-food translation, and analyses its main features according to specific evaluation criteria previously determined so as to measure their suitability regarding translators’ terminological needs in the agri-food translation sector.
4. Two chapters from the volume *Agroalimentación: lenguajes de especialidad y traducción* volumen (Rivas Carmona & Veroz González, 2018): “Wine blogs: a genre that allows for new descriptions use” (Zarco-Tejada, 2018) and “La traducción de las páginas web de las bodegas de Córdoba y su provincia: con-

texto actual y propuesta de mejora” (Ramírez Almansa, 2018). These two articles have been chosen because, as students have to work with and translate winery texts for unit 2, they will help students learn techniques and strategies to translate technical texts dealing with wine.

2.2 Unit 1: Text typology in agri-food translation

Unit 1 is focused on text typology in agri-food translation. It is important that students understand that establishing the most relevant features of agri-food texts entails difficulty since, as Rivas Carmona & Ruiz Romero (2021, p. 25) point out, “the agri-food field is complex and multidimensional”.

In order to approach text typology in agri-food translation, Unit 1 starts with the reading of three chapters focused on genre and text typology: 1) “Un concepto fundamental: el género” from *La traducción de textos técnicos* (Gamero Pérez, 2001); 2) several pages from “La traducción como operación textual” from *Traducción y Traductología* (Hurtado Albir, 2001); and 3) “Textual typologisation of the the agri-food field” from *Feeding the Future: Text Typology in Agri-Food Translation* (Rivas Carmona & Ruiz Romero, 2021). We find very relevant the classification by Rivas Carmona & Ruiz Romero (2021) for two main reasons: first, it is tailored to the particularities of agri-food field and, second, it covers a very broad range of texts.

The activity for Unit 1 is devoted to identifying 7 text types in agri-food translation following the textual typologization by Rivas Carmona & Ruiz Romero (2021). This activity is worth 20% of the mark. Owing to limitations of space, below are shown extracts from the 7 texts as well very brief descriptions of each text.

Text 1

High-speed identification system for fresh tea leaves based on phenotypic characteristics utilizing an improved genetic algorithm

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Abstract

High-quality tea requires leaves of similar size and tenderness. The grade of the fresh leaves determines the quality of the tea. The automated classification of fresh tea leaves improves resource utilization and reduces manual picking costs. The present study proposes a method based on an improved genetic algorithm for identifying fresh tea leaves in high-speed parabolic motion using the

phenotypic characteristics of the leaves. During parabolic flight, light is transmitted through the tea leaves, and six types of fresh tea leaves can be quickly identified by a camera.

The influence of combinations of morphology, color, and custom corner-point morphological features on the classification results were investigated, and the necessary dimensionality of the model was tested. After feature selection and combination, the classification performance of the Naive Bayes, k-nearest neighbor, and support vector machine algorithms were compared. The recognition time of Naive Bayes was the shortest, whereas the accuracy of support vector machine had the best classification accuracy at approximately 97%. The support vector machine algorithm with only three feature dimensions (equivalent diameter, circularity, and skeleton endpoints) can meet production requirements with an accuracy rate reaching 92.5%.

Text 1 is an extract of an agri-scientific text, specifically a specialized article on high-speed system to identify fresh tea leaves (Gan et al., 2022).

Text 2

OPERATING INSTRUCTIONS

JUICING FUNCTION

Press [ON] button on the back of the Omega® Nutrition System to start.

Gradually put the ingredients into the hopper chute and press down with the pusher.

DO NOT place any metal objects into the hopper. If the drum set is clogged or the machine stops operating, press the reverse button 2 to 3 times and press the ON button again to resume normal operation.

After the extraction or processing is complete, place the switch in the stop position to stop.

WARNING When using [ON] or [Rev] button, make sure that the auger stops completely.

Turn the adjustable end cap counter clockwise to tighten the squeeze, increasing the pressure. Turn the adjustable end cap clockwise to loosen the pressure.

To yield more juice from Celery, Herbs, and Leafy Greens, use the adjustable end cap with the green inner ring. Turn the end cap counter clockwise to tighten the squeeze, increasing the pressure. Turn the end cap clockwise to loosen the pressure.

OPERATING NOTES

This heavy-duty nutrition system features a patented, stone mill-like auger, made of hygienic U.S. FDA-approved melamine. The low speed of 80 RPMs ensures full taste and the highest nutritional value.

Text 2 is an extract from a technical text for practical use, specifically the user manual of the Omega MM900 Low Speed Celery Juicer Extractor (Omega Juicers, n.d.).

Text 3

The Science Underlying the Dietary Guidelines Demonstrates That Healthy Eating Across the Lifespan Can Promote Health and Reduce Risk of Chronic Disease

Birth Through 23 Months

- Lower risk of overweight and obesity
- Lower risk of type 1 diabetes
- Adequate iron status and lower risk of iron deficiency
- Lower risk of peanut allergy
- Lower risk of asthma

Children and Adolescents

- Lower adiposity
- Lower total and low-density lipoprotein (LDL) cholesterol

Women Who Are Pregnant or Lactating

- Favorable cognitive development in the child
- Favorable folate status in women during pregnancy and lactation

Adults, Including Older Adults

- Lower risk of all-cause mortality
- Lower risk of cardiovascular disease
- Lower risk of cardiovascular disease mortality
- Lower total and LDL cholesterol
- Lower blood pressure
- Lower risk of obesity
- Lower body mass index, waist circumference, and body fat

Text 3 is an extract from the *Dietary Guidelines for Americans, 2020–2025* (U.S. Department of Agriculture and U.S. Department of Health and Human Services, 2020) and it would be classified as a semi-specialized agri-health text.

Text 4

Regulation (EC) No 178/2002 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 28 January 2002

laying down the general principles and requirements of food law, establishing the European Food Safety Authority and laying down procedures in matters of food safety

THE EUROPEAN PARLIAMENT AND THE COUNCIL OF THE EUROPEAN UNION,

Having regard to the Treaty establishing the European Community, and in particular Articles 37, 95, 133 and Article 152(4)(b) thereof,

Having regard to the proposal from the Commission(1),

Having regard to the opinion of the Economic and Social Committee(2),

Having regard to the opinion of the Committee of the Regions(3),

Acting in accordance with the procedure laid down in Article 251 of the Treaty(4),

Whereas:

- (1) The free movement of safe and wholesome food is an essential aspect of the internal market and contributes significantly to the health and well-being of citizens, and to their social and economic interests.
- (2) A high level of protection of human life and health should be assured in the pursuit of Community policies.

Text 4 is an extract from the Regulation no. 178/2002 laying down procedures in matters of food safety (European Parliament and the Council of the European Union, 2002) Consequently, it is a specialized regulatory text that belongs to the agri-legal text type.

Text 5

Ruta de la Pasa. Tradiciones malagueñas recobradas

Es llamada así por los innumerables paseros que la componen, dispuestos en suaves pendientes siempre orientadas al sur. Su vino, elaborado artesanalmente, es bastante apreciado, especialmente el moscatel.

Comienza la ruta en Moclinejo, un pueblo que hace siglos fue protagonista del levantamiento contra las tropas cristianas, acontecimiento que ha pasado a la historia con el nombre de La Batalla de la Axarquía. Siguiendo por la senda que nos marcan los paseros se llega hasta Almáchar, donde el viajero podrá disfrutar de su exquisito ajoblanco. El Borge, situado a solo 2,5 kilómetros de Almáchar, asumió el liderazgo como foco de rebeldía durante el citado levantamiento morisco. Este carácter rebelde del pueblo seguía aún vivo algunos siglos después, en la figura de uno de los más famosos bandoleros de Málaga ‘El Bizco del Borge’.

Ruta tras la uva de Málaga, el origen del vino dulce de la Axarquía, el vino moscatel

Muy próximo a los 1.020 metros del Pico Santopitar, bajo la atenta mirada del pico de La Maroma, está situada Cútar que, además de distinguirse por sus uvas y pasas, también es la cuna de un excelente aceite. Comares es conocida como el Balcón de la Axarquía, por la espléndida vista que se contempla desde el pueblo.

Text 5 describes part of the “Ruta de la pasa” (“Raisin route”) in Málaga, extracted from the web page “Rutas de turismo gastronómico” (Rutas de turismo gastronómico, 2019). It is then an agro-tourist text.

Text 6

Text 6 is an example of an agri-advertising text. It is a campaign poster of the Breakfast in the Classroom program created by the New York City Department of Education (Platkin, 2017).



Figure 1: Breakfast in the Classroom. New York City Department of Education (Platkin, 2017).

Text 7

Sweet potato fishcakes

Chopped salad, feta & red pepper salsa

"White fish is a great choice here, as it's both low in fat and super-nutritious. Haddock, for example, is packed full of iodine, which we need to support healthy brain function."

Ingredients

500 g potatoes, 500 g sweet potatoes, 2 red peppers, extra virgin olive oil, 2 teaspoons chipotle Tabasco sauce, 500 g white fish fillets from sustainable sources, skin off, pin-boned olive oil, 1 cucumber, 1 iceberg lettuce, 1 heaped teaspoon English mustard, 4 heaped tablespoons natural yoghurt, 1 tablespoon white wine vinegar, 40 g feta cheese, ½ a bunch of fresh mint, (15g), 1 lemon.

Method

Wash 500g each of potatoes and sweet potatoes (leaving the skins on for extra nutritional benefit), chop into 3cm chunks and cook in a pan of boiling salted water for 15 minutes, or until cooked through. Drain, leave to steam dry and cool, then mash.

Meanwhile, blacken 2 red peppers over a direct flame on the hob or in a griddle pan on a high heat, turning until charred and blistered all over.

Pop into a bowl and cover with clingfilm for 10 minutes, then scrape off most of the black skin, discarding the stalks and seeds. Finely chop, dress with 1 tablespoon of extra virgin olive oil and 2 teaspoons of chipotle Tabasco, then put aside.

Text 7 is an extract from a recipe (Oliver, 2023). Recipes are classified as agri-culinary texts.

2.3 Unit 2: Advertising agri-food translation

Unit 2 deals with the translation of agri-food texts containing advertising. As it has been mentioned in the introduction, this Unit will focus on winery advertising texts and, more specifically, on the genre “winery presentation” and the text type “web page”. Therefore, the activity for Unit 2 will be translating a section from the Australian Montalto winery as well as carrying out other tasks that will be detailed below.

Before carrying out the activity, students are expected to read three articles: 1) “Publicidad, vitivinicultura y traducción” (Sánchez Nieto, 2006), where the genre “winery presentation” is analysed and compared in English and German; 2) “Las estrategias de internacionalización en la traducción publicitaria” (De Pedro Ricoy, 2007), an article arguing that there is a degree of coincidence between translation theory and the principles of international marketing; and 3) the section “Techniques, strategies, problems and errors” from *Traducción y Traductología* (Hurtado Albir, 2001), where key translation notions are explained.

Another important aspect of the activity for Unit 2 is the fact that it encompasses compiling a parallel bilingual (English-Spanish) virtual corpus. It is worth mentioning that two methodological courses offered at Semester One (or Fall Semester) are compulsory for students: “Information Resources and Localization” and “Resources for Literary, Legal, and Scientific Translation”. These two courses provide an introduction to parallel and comparable virtual corpora and their use as translation resources. They also present different corpora management software such as AntConc, Sketch Engine or ParaConc and offer hands-on practice activities to compile virtual corpora. Therefore, students know the basic concepts of corpora use and compilation when they start the “Agri-food translation (English-Spanish)” course at Semester Two (or Spring Semester).

Using corpora in this course is justified because lack of appropriate terminological and lexicographical resources is one of the major obstacles that translators face when dealing with specialized translation. Virtual corpora can compensate for this shortage of resources as they allow translators to create and exploit their own terminological material. The combination of bilingual virtual corpora and any corpora management software helps translators find very quickly no-cost high-quality terminological, phraseological, and thematic resources. Its use is proven to be beneficial for translation lecturers and professional translators and/or interpreters (Toledo-Báez, 2020).

Montalto Winery in Australia is having more and more Spanish-speaking visitors. Thus, they decided to translate its web page into Spanish (from Spain). You are the translator commissioned to translate the web page.

1. Visit the Montalto web page and learn about the winery: <https://montalto.com.au/>
 2. List 10 winery terms that are new for you. How are you facing their translation? What are your terminological sources for the translation?
 3. To help you with the translation, visit other winery web pages written in both English and Spanish (for instance, Alvear Winery, Toro Albalá, etc.).
 4. Compile a parallel (same content in English and Spanish) bilingual virtual corpus of at least 10 winery presentations.
 5. Use ParaConc (a software to manage parallel corpora) to search terms, equivalents and collocates for your translation. If necessary, create a English-Spanish glossary for your translation.
 6. Translate the web page using a Word document.
 7. According to the chapter “Techniques, strategies, problems and errors” from *Traducción y Traductología* (Hurtado Albir, 2001), deliver a report specifying, on the one hand, the problems encountered with the solutions found, and, on the other hand, the techniques and strategies used.
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A short version of activity for Unit 2, which is worth 20% of the mark, is detailed below.

2.4 Unit 3: Culinary translation

Unit 3 is devoted to culinary translation, specifically to restaurant menu translation. The three readings for this unit are the following: 1) the issue 13 from *La Linterna del Traductor* journal (Hoyos Seijo, 2016), which is focused on culinary translation; 2) the article “An Approach to Analyzing the Quality of Menu Translation in Southern Spain Restaurants.” (Fuentes-Luque, 2017) and 3) the article “A corpus-based multimodal approach to the translation of restaurant menus” (Li, 2019).

Students need to know that translating restaurant menus has always been a priority at major tourist destinations such as Andalusia in southern Spain (Fuentes-Luque, 2017). However, having restaurant menus translated has become

a necessity in Europe due to the fact that, according to specific legislation on food safety (European Parliament and the Council of the European Union, 2011), the information on allergens must be provided in written form and, if possible, in several languages (Chartered Trading Standards Institute, 2021).

Given that providing multilingual menus is now a health concern, professional translation is made even more relevant as a top-quality guarantee (Li, 2019). Considering that the hospitality industry is still reluctant to commission translation of menus to professional translators, professional menu software offering translation emerges as a middle ground solution. Menutech software-as-a-service (European Commission, 2018) has been created to automatize, among others, allergen labelling and menu translation. Menutech translations have two main sources: on the one hand, curated certified sources such as cooking books and recipe databases and, on the other hand, Google Translate.

Consequently, the activity for Unit 3 offers students the possibility of using Menutech, a professional menu software to translate restaurant menus from English into Spanish and from Spanish into English. Before carrying out the activity, the course lecturer will organize a virtual seminar to explain the software basics and help students with any question they may have about how to translate with it.

A short version of activity for Unit 3, which is worth 20% of the mark, is detailed below.

Menutech is a professional menu software that translate restaurant menus using, on the one hand, curated certified sources such as cooking books and recipe databases and, on the other hand, machine translation from Google Translate. You are commissioned to translate two restaurant menus (one from English into Spanish and another one from Spanish into English) using Menutech.

1. Create your Menutech trial account at <https://menutech.com/es>. If necessary, rewatch the recording of the virtual seminar on how to use Menutech for translating restaurant menus.
 2. Translate the *La hora del tapeo* menu (<https://www.thefork.es/restaurante/la-hora-del-tapeo-r747645/menu>) into English using Menutech. If necessary, modify the translation suggested by Menutech.
 3. Write a brief report on the *La hora del tapeo* menu translation. Which errors have you found? Have you found good or very good equivalents? Which elements have you modified? Have you felt comfortable using Menutech? Do you prefer translating from scratch or using Menutech?
 4. Translate the *Bill's Restaurant* menu (<https://bills-website.co.uk/menus/>) into Spanish using Menutech. If necessary, modify the translation suggested by Menutech.
 5. Write a brief report on the *La hora del tapeo* menu translation. Which errors have you found? Have you found good or very good equivalents? Which elements have you modified? Have you felt comfortable using Menutech? Do you prefer translating from scratch or using Menutech?
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2.5 Unit 4: Scientific agri-food translation

Unit 4 is focused on scientific agri-food translation and the genre chosen for the activity of this Unit is a scientific article. Scientific articles are the final product of research activity and their impact in expert community depends not only on its scientific originality, but also on its communicative effectiveness. This is where translating scientific articles comes into play making their content widely available.

The readings for this Unit are the following: 1) “La traducción científico-técnica: aportaciones desde los Estudios de Traducción” (Franco Aixelà, 2013); 2) chapter “Cómo mejorar la redacción y la traducción científicas” from *Cómo traducir y redactar textos científicos en español. Reglas, ideas y consejos* (Claros Díaz, 2016); and 3) “Diez errores usuales en la traducción de artículos científicos” (Amador Domínguez, 2007).

It is worth mentioning that the activity for Unit 4 also entails the compilation of a comparable bilingual corpora. A short version of activity for Unit 4, which is worth 40% of the mark, is detailed below.

A Spanish food journal would like to publish an extract from the article “Applications of nanotechnology to combat the problems associated with modern food” (<https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/epdf/10.1002/jsfa.12146>), originally published in the *Journal of Science of Food and Agriculture*. You are commissioned to translate the extract.

1. Read the whole article.
 2. Compile a comparable (different texts in English and Spanish) bilingual virtual corpus of at least 10 ten articles on the same topic as the source text.
 3. Use AntConc or Sketch Engine to search terms, equivalents and collocates for your translation. If necessary, create a English-Spanish glossary for your translation.
 4. Translate the extract from the article.
 5. According to the chapter “Techniques, strategies, problems and errors” from *Traducción y Traductología* (Hurtado Albir, 2001), deliver a report specifying, on the one hand, the problems encountered with the solutions found, and, on the other hand, the techniques and strategies used.
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3 Conclusions

The agri-food sector is key for the Spanish economy having a GVA of 107,743 billion euros, which accounts for 9.6% of GDP. Despite the fact that translators could contribute to the export activity and the internationalization of agri-food companies, agri-food translation is a pending subject in Spanish academia and it is taught only in 9 out of 29 Universities.

In this chapter we have detailed the revised designing of the “Agri-food translation (English–Spanish)” virtual course taught at the Master’s Degree in Translation of Specialized Texts at the University of Córdoba (Spain) during 2019–2020 and 2020–2021. Following a constructivist teaching method along with a task-based learning approach, the purpose of the course is familiarizing students with agri-food translation. Starting with an introduction to agri-food translation, the course is divided into four main units: 1) text typology in agri-food translation; 2) advertising agri-food translation; 3) culinary translation and 4) scientific agri-food translation. The main innovation of this course is the introduction of translation technology for agri-food translation, combining both parallel and comparable bilingual virtual corpora (Units 2 and 4) and the professional software menu Menutech (Unit 3).

Unit 1 is focused on text typology in agri-food translation. After the reading of three chapters focused on genre and text typology, the activity for Unit 1 is devoted to identifying 7 text types in agri-food translation following the textual typologization by Rivas Carmona & Ruiz Romero (2021).

Unit 2 deals with the translation of agri-food texts containing advertising and it will focus on “winery presentation”. Therefore, the activity for Unit 2 will be translating a section from the Australian Montalto winery web page. Another important aspect of the activity for Unit 2 is the fact that it encompasses compiling a parallel bilingual (English-Spanish) virtual corpus.

Unit 3 is devoted to culinary translation, specifically to restaurant menu translation. An innovative aspect of the activity to be carried out is that offers students the possibility of using Menutech, a professional menu software to translate restaurant menus from English into Spanish and from Spanish into English.

Unit 4 is focused on scientific agri-food translation and the genre chosen for the activity of this Unit is a scientific article. Students will be asked to translate an extract from a scientific article as well as to compile a comparable virtual corpus of at least 10 ten articles on the same topic as the source text.

The future direction of our proposal is the real implementation of the course. If necessary, two elements would be used to evaluate the course: 1) Feedback from students and 2) a SWOT (Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, and Threats) analysis (Romero Gutiérrez et al., 2015).

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